

Morning Headlines — Tuesday, 07 July 2026

A day defined by war, diplomacy, and disaster: Russia pounds Kyiv as NATO leaders convene in Ankara, Hamas makes a historic governance concession in Gaza, a Category 5 typhoon batters U.S. Pacific islands, and Wall Street closes at a record high.

top 5 · last 24 hours

Russia's Massive Drone and Missile Barrage Kills 22 in Kyiv, Exposing Air-Defense Gaps — [NPR](#) / [multiple outlets](#)

~18h ago · [Ukraine](#) / [Europe](#)

Russia fired 351 drones and 68 missiles at Ukraine overnight Monday, killing at least 22 people in Kyiv alone; all 29 ballistic missiles struck their targets as Ukraine's Patriot interceptor stockpiles run critically low. The attack underscores a widening vulnerability in Ukraine's air defenses more than four years into the full-scale invasion.

NATO Summit Opens in Ankara With Trump Pressing Allies on Defense Spending — [Al Jazeera](#) / [CNN](#)

~6h ago · [Geopolitics](#) / [Europe](#)

Leaders from all 32 NATO member states, including President Trump and Ukrainian President Zelenskyy, gathered in Ankara today for the alliance's 36th summit, with Secretary General Rutte centering the agenda on defense investment, industrial production, and continued support for Ukraine. Trump is expected to demand concrete follow-through on last year's pledges to raise defense budgets.

Hamas Dissolves Gaza Government, Agrees to Hand Power to U.N.-Backed Committee — [CNN](#) /

[Washington Post](#) / [CBC News](#)

~20h ago · [Middle East](#)

Hamas announced it is disbanding its decade-old governing administration in Gaza and transferring civilian affairs to a U.N.-backed technocratic committee based in Cairo — a key condition of the U.S.-brokered ceasefire — though the group stopped short of any commitment to disarm. Israel dismissed the move as a 'stunt,' and negotiations over the ceasefire's second phase remain deadlocked.

Category 5 Super Typhoon Bavi Devastates U.S. Northern Mariana Islands and Guam — [Al Jazeera](#) /

[NPR](#) / [Yale Climate Connections](#)

~22h ago · [Pacific](#) / [Natural Disaster](#)

Super Typhoon Bavi made direct landfall on the island of Rota with 180 mph winds on Monday, inflicting what local officials described as 'major damages' across the Northern Mariana Islands and northern Guam — the third Category 5 storm of 2026. The storm is now tracking toward Japan's Ryukyu Islands and is forecast to make landfall in northern Taiwan.

S&P 500 Notches New Record Close as Tech Stocks Lead Market Rally — [CNBC](#)

~14h ago · [Markets](#) / [Economy](#)

The S&P 500 gained 0.72% to close at a record 7,537 and the Dow Jones rose to a record 53,055 on Monday, driven by broad strength in semiconductors and tech; the index has now returned 10.2% in the first half of 2026. The gains came despite a softer-than-expected June jobs report — 57,000 payrolls added versus a 113,000 forecast — which some investors read as reducing pressure on the Fed to raise rates.
